

Lab - Create a Virtual install of CSI Linux Using VirtualBox (2024)

Caveat

Be sure to read through the lab in its entirety before starting this or any lab in the course! Skipping a step in any part of the lab will cause the lab to fail. Trying to blow through this lab will result in epic failure! Slow and steady wins the race.

Requirements:

1. CSI Linux VirtualBox Image: (~10 GB)
2. VirtualBox: (~107 MB)
3. CPU that supports Virtualization.
4. 16 GB of RAM preferred. (8 GB of RAM will Suffice but would not be optimal)
5. At least 60 GB of free hard drive space. (An external hard drive or thumb drive can also be used as storage)

Using Other Hypervisors

For all the gunslingers in the course, if you are using some other hypervisor to create your virtual lab environment, you are good to go. No need to check with the instructor.

This lab will walk through creating and installing a CSI Linux virtual machine using VirtualBox using a prebuilt image. CSI Linux will function as our forensic toolkit for some of the subsequent labs.

Install using a prebuilt CSI Linux VB Image (preferred)

This installation process can take as much time as your resources will allow, depending on your resource specifics, i.e., computer, internet connection speed, and so on.

All the software used in the lab is free and open source, just like CSI Linux.

As the lab begins, students will be taken through the download process for all downloads. All software has been verified to be malware and crapware free.

Begin the lab!

Install CSI Linux in VirtualBox (using VBOX file)

1. Download and install VirtualBox.

If you already have an installation of VirtualBox, you can skip this portion of the lab.

The first step is to download and install the **VirtualBox** software package onto the host machine chosen for your lab setup. Make sure you download the correct version for your operating system and hardware architecture (32 bit vs. 64 bit). Instructions for installation on various operating systems are readily available if you run into any snags. Also, make sure to keep a handy copy of the [VirtualBox user manual](#), which comes packaged with the software and can also be found online.

Once downloaded, **VirtualBox** installs like any other software program. Find your download and begin installing it. **VirtualBox** is malware and crapware free. Once you install VirtualBox and run it for the first time, you'll be presented with the application's welcome prompt, which provides an orientation for the interface. Navigate through the menus to get a feel for the software.

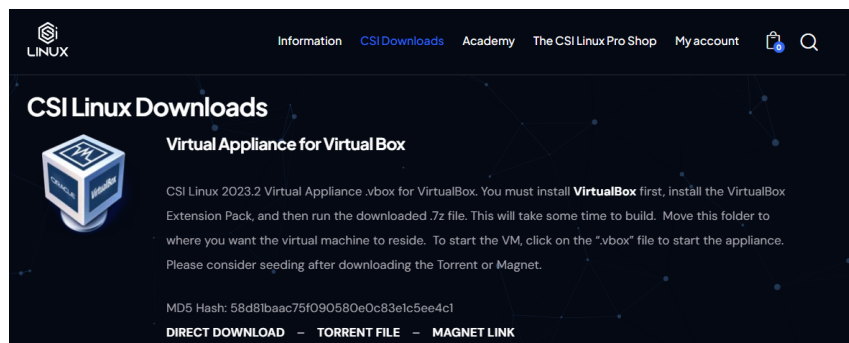
[Download here!](#)

2. Download the CSI Linux VirtualBox image

Using a pre-installed file saves us a lot of time as we won't have to step through the installation process.

Since the CSI Linux images are updated over time, the download file version may differ from what is in the lab. Regardless, it remains the same file but with significant revisions.

Visit the [CSI Linux download site](#) for the latest image.



Caveat

This is a large download. If you need additional space for the download or the creation of the CSI Linux virtual machine, you can use a USB thumb drive for both.

Download the VBOX file directly.

Click on the direct download link. On the next screen, save the download to the location of your choice. Your default should be your download directory. Just remember where you save the download.

The download saves as a 7zip archive. This is a free open-source archiving utility much like WinZip or WINRAR. You will need 7zip to extract the CSI Linux VBOX file.

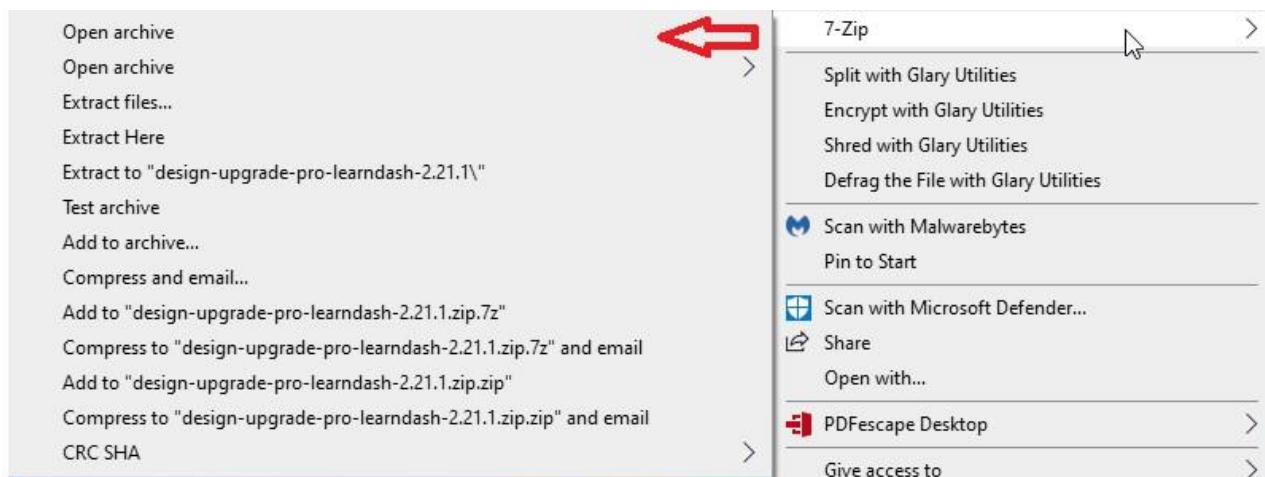
Point your browser to <https://www.7-zip.org/download.html>

Find the version that works for your operating system. Download the 7zip installer and when completed, x2 click to launch. Complete the installation.

Download 7-Zip 23.01 (2023-06-20):

Link	Type	System	Description
Download	.exe	64-bit Windows x64	7-Zip installer for Windows
Download	.exe	32-bit Windows x86	
Download	.exe	64-bit Windows arm64	

7zip is now part of your cursors content menu.



Extract your CSI Linux Image

Once CSI Linux has downloaded, browse over to the download location where the download was saved, right click on the image and from the context menu, select 7zip and from the 7zip context menu, select, Extract Here.

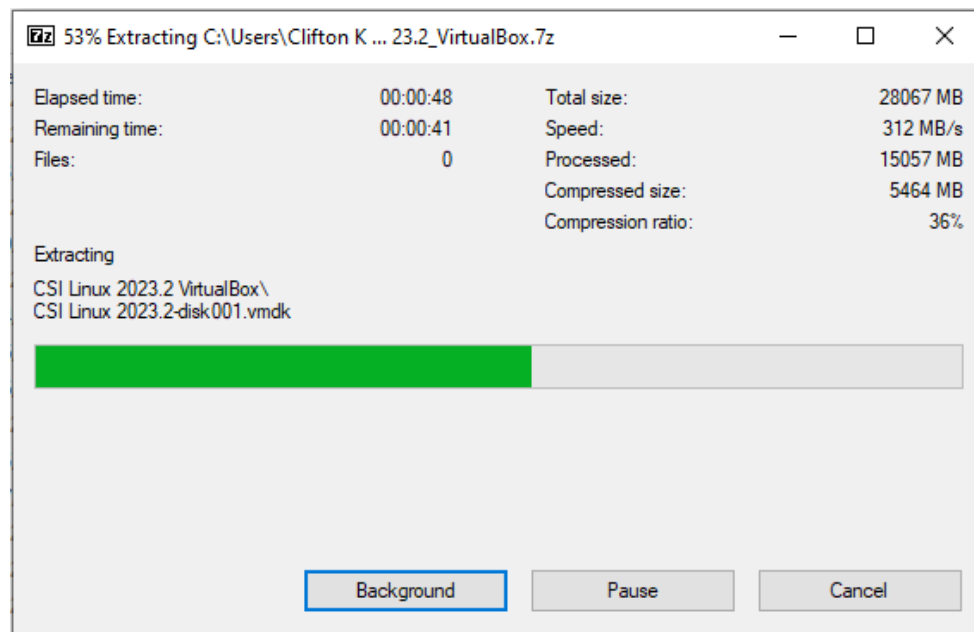
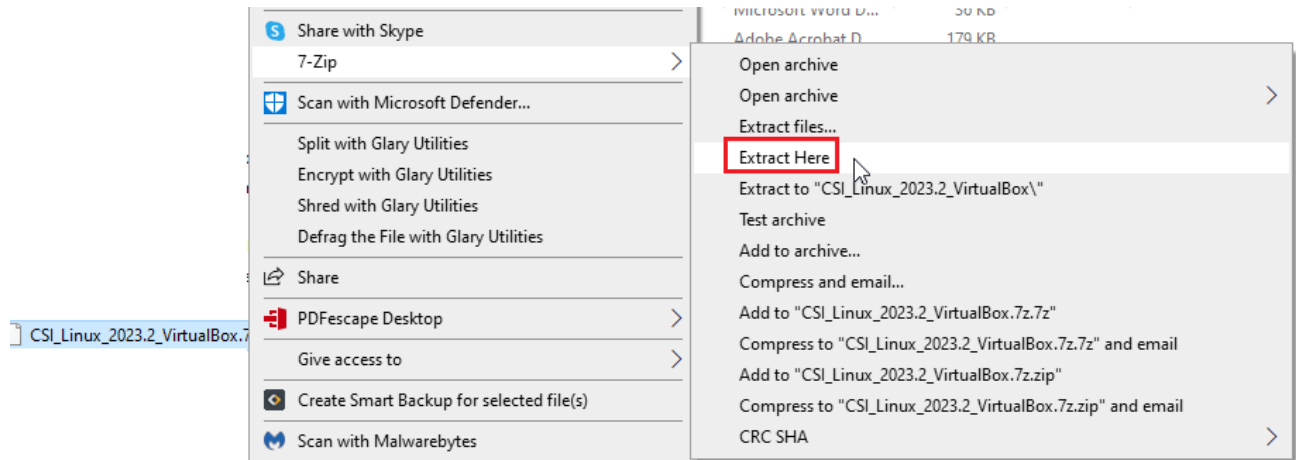
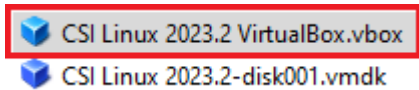


Figure 1 CSI Linux Extraction

Find the extracted folder.

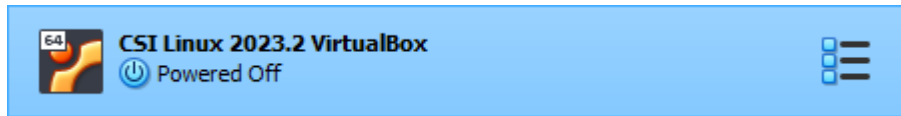
 CSI Linux 2023.2 VirtualBox

Open the extracted folder, and inside, find and double-click the vbox file.



VirtualBox opens and your virtual installation of CSI Linux is ready to be launched.

Inside of your VirtualBox management console, x2 click CSI Linux to launch.



When CSI Linux starts to boot, let the machine roll on.



Username and password update for CSI Linux 2023.2

The login for CSI Linux is: **csi**

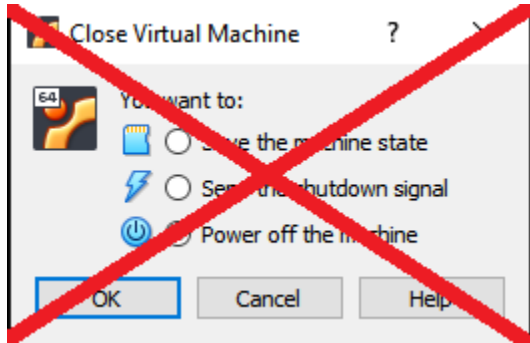


Press enter.

Congratulations, you now have a virtual instance of CSI Linux installed on your computer!

How to Restart or Shut Down CSI Linux Gracefully.

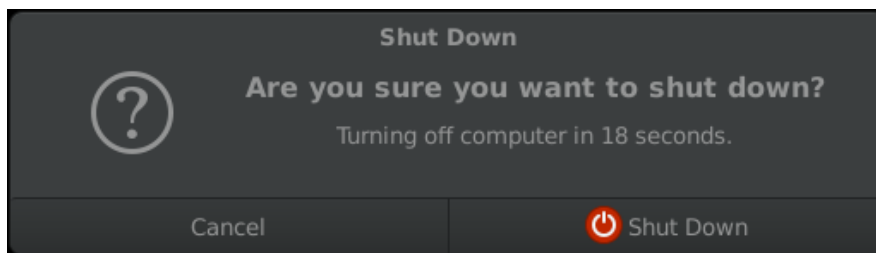
To shut down or restart CSI Linux, do gracefully as if you were shutting down or restarting your host machine. **Do not just power off CSI Linux, as this will corrupt your CSI Linux installation!**



To log-off, restart, or shut down, click on the one of the three buttons from the top right of your CSI Linux screen. To restart, use the green button.



The following screen pops up. Select your option.



Updating Your CSI Linux Install

Rules to follow when updating CSI Linux:

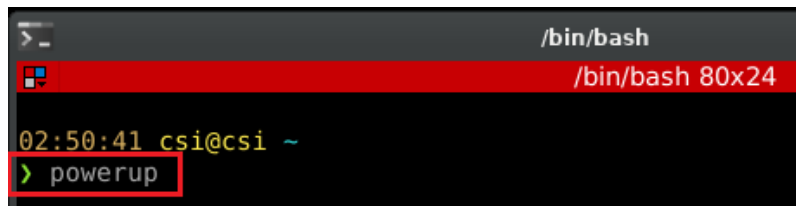
- You must be patient!
- You must not interrupt the update process!

- You need to update, or things will not work as described in the lab.

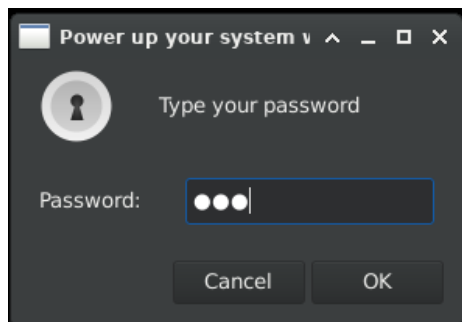
To update CSI Linux, open a terminal session. Find the terminal icon located in the bottom taskbar.



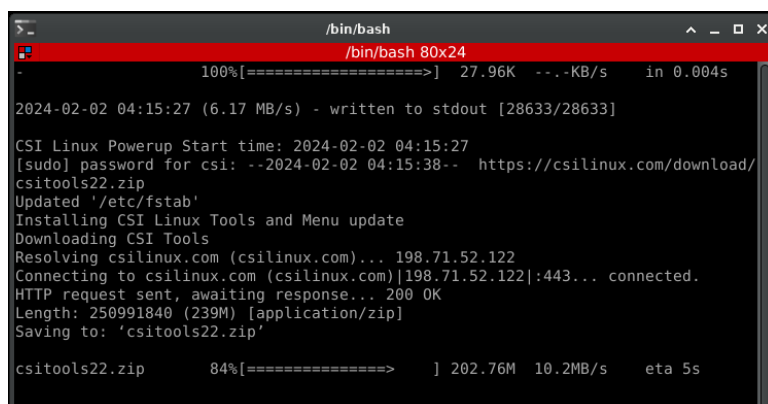
At the terminal prompt, type the following all lower case: **powerup**



You will be prompted for your CSI Linux password: csi



The update process begins.

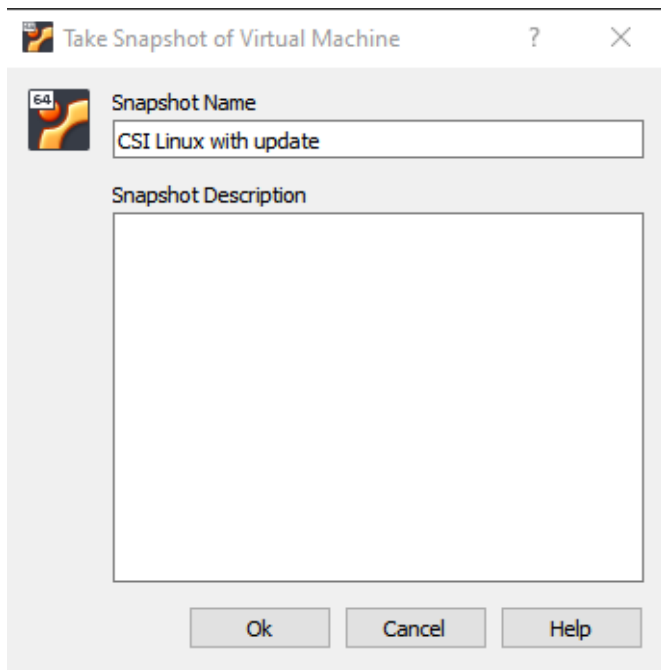


Taking a Snapshot of CSI Linux

The basic idea of a snapshot is you have set up your virtual machine precisely the way you want it. Once we take a snapshot, we can make any changes we want. If CSI Linux becomes corrupted or we would like a fresh install, all you need to do is roll back the snapshot, and our virtual machine will be exactly how it was before when we took the snapshot.

With CSI Linux up and running from the left windowpane, click on, Machine, and from the context menu, select the Take snapshot.

Give the Snapshot a user-friendly name. Click OK.

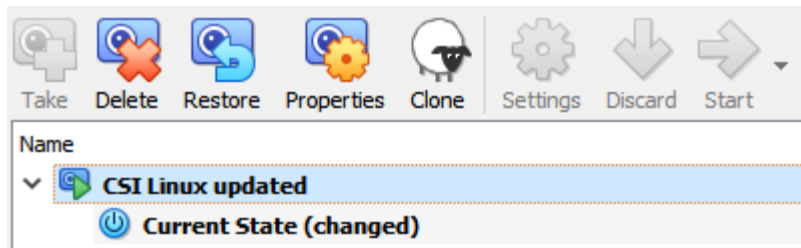


VirtualBox saves the machine state.

Restore your machine's state using a Snapshot.

To restore using your newly created snapshot, shut CSI Linux down (gracefully!)

From the VirtualBox management console, from the right windowpane, you will see your saved Snapshot.



With the machine turned off, select the virtual machine to restore, Next, highlight the saved snapshot, and click the Restore icon, the machine will be restored to its previous state when you next power on the machine.

End of the lab!